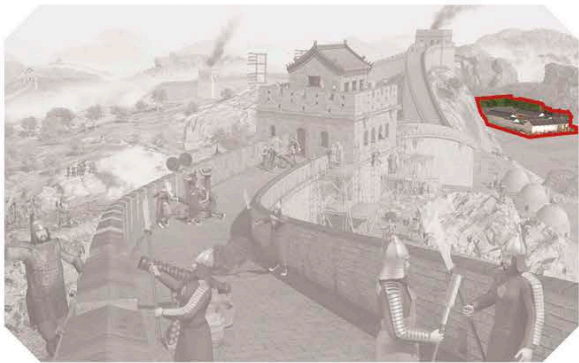


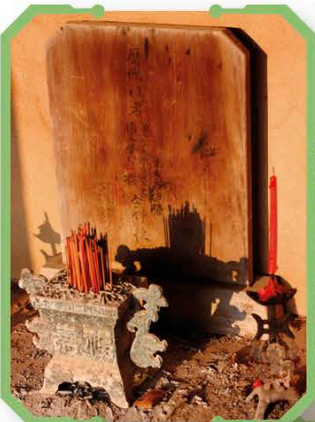
VILLAGE LIFE

Soldiers and their families live in villages next to the Wall, with troops heading there when it was their turn to do guard duty. Farmers liked being close to the Wall as they could sell their produce to the troops. Farm and village houses were both usually based around an enclosed “courtyard” design.

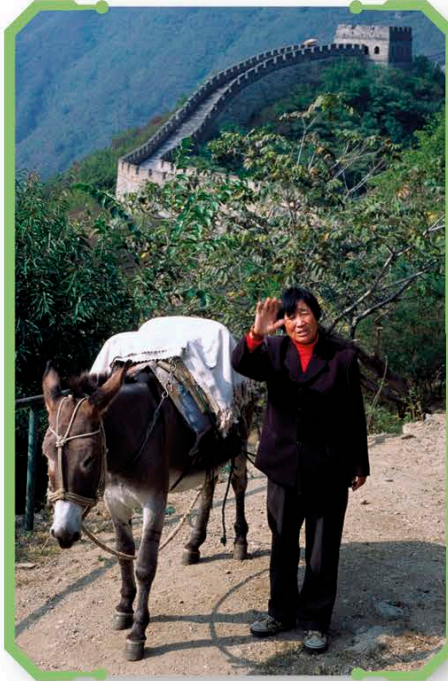


House roofs are plain, without the carved roof guardians seen on temples and Great Wall guard towers.

The roof overhangs the courtyard to provide shade in summertime



Ancestor worship
Most Chinese houses had an altar or shrine where incense was burned, and gifts and offerings were left to honor dead family members. This is known as ancestor worship and many Chinese people still practice it today.



Animal helpers
Farmers used donkeys to move heavy loads in wicker or straw baskets strapped to their sides. Donkeys are still seen today, working hard on the steep hills near the Great Wall where cars and trucks cannot go.

The outside walls have no windows. This gives the house privacy and security.

This medium-size pen is for donkeys. They spend their days working, so for them the pen is a place to rest.

“I dig the well from which I drink. I farm the soil which yields my food. I share creation. Kings can do no more.”

—Traditional Chinese proverb

The pen for goats is the largest outdoor part of the farm.